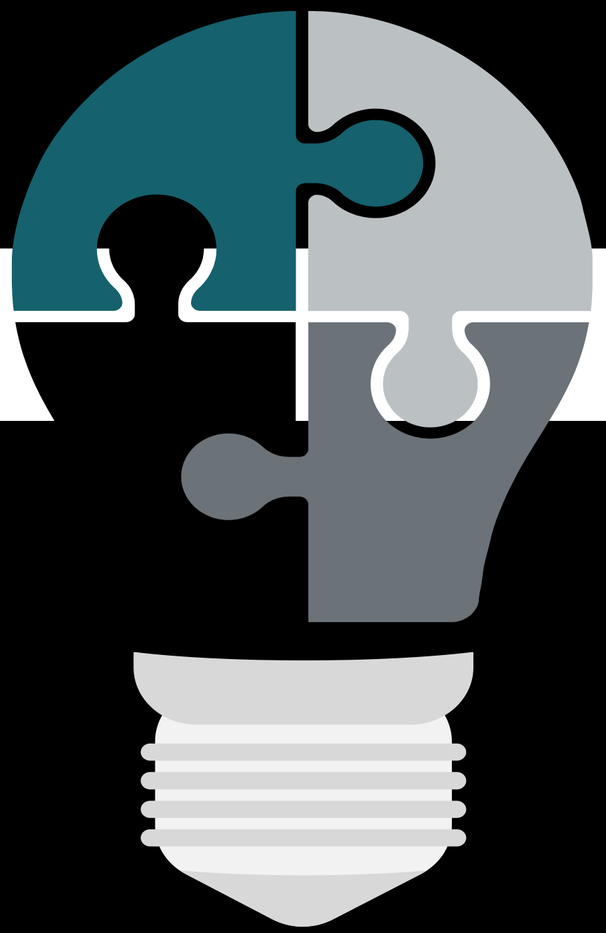
AI Automation Playbook

MAP AND DESIGN THE AI WORKFLOW



Build the AI Automation Proposal

INSTRUCTIONS: GETTING STARTED

Complete your assignment on the following slides
Set the share settings so **anyone with the link** can view the document
Submit the link to this deck in the Learning Management System

Tips for completing your assignment:

- Rename your copy and add your name to the file
  Example: Playbook Assignment: Automation opportunity scan-MRogers
- Read each slide carefully to ensure you complete the assignment successfully
- Review your playbook before submitting for accuracy, grammar and spelling

Watch this video for a quick demo

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INSTRUCTIONS: Introduction to the assignment

For this playbook assignment, you will **build an AI Automation Proposal.**

You will choose either our provided scenario, Swift Supply Co or create your own. If you choose your own, you will pick a workflow to use from your company, a past workplace, or a business context you're familiar with.

Option A: Use the provided scenario: Swift Supply Co. - As with past playbook assignments, you can use the Swift Supply Co. scenario. If you select this option, follow slides 4-18.

Option B: Use your own scenario - If you already have a process in mind from the Automation opportunity scan playbook, you can use that to build your proposal. If you select this option, follow slides 19 - 31.

By the end of this playbook assignment you should have completed the following proposal elements:

- ❏ Current process
- ❏ Proposed process
- ❏ AI feasibility review
- ❏ Metrics
- ❏ Stakeholder review
- ❏ Risks & mitigations
- ❏ Executive summary
- ❏ Self -assessment

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COMPANY OVERVIEW: Swift Supply Co.

Swift Supply Co. is a mid-sized company that sells office supplies, workplace essentials, and business furniture to both individual consumers and corporate clients. They sell via their online store, retail distribution partners (office supply, big-box stores) and directly to large corporate customers.

The customer service team manages customer interactions for all orders, shipping, returns and related questions. They are overwhelmed with too many inquiries to process in a timely way, resulting in delayed and/or erroneous responses, frustrated customers and partners, missed business opportunities, and reputational harm.

You believe a bot delivered via AI automation can provide order details easily and efficiently while forwarding on more complicated inquiries to an agent. Your goal is to thoroughly consider applying AI automation to this problem, bringing along stakeholders and ultimately **present this proposal** to leadership with a recommendation for its implementation.

REVIEW | COMPLETE | REFLECT | SUBMIT

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COMPLETE: Project goal

What is the goal of implementing this AI automation? What short term and long term benefits will result?

Keeping the following key line in mind; "The customer service team manages customer interactions for all orders, shipping, returns and related questions."

A Phased Approach would be suggested. Dependent on current system architecture pattern, functionality could be broken out by the following: Orders, Shipping, and Returns.

Each would represent a Phase of Automation; providing the initial short-term and immediate metrics as to the success and/or failure in real-time. Long-term it will drive what Agentic AI/Traditional Automation means to the Swift Supply Company infrastructure and how they may benefit overall. This phased approach will also allow our overwhelmed support resources the necessary time to adequately transition themselves to successful 'Account Managers'. For our efforts we will be focused on Phase 1 - Order Tracking System and proceed from there.

Cost Analysis Follows:

Metric (Per Month)	Current (Manual)	With Make.com AI	Savings / Delta
Inquiry Capacity	2,000 Tickets	2,000 Tickets	Same Staff
Cost Per Ticket	$12.50	$1.15	90% Reduction
Response Time	4–24 Hours	< 10 Seconds	Instant
Direct Labor Cost	$25,000	$2,300	$22,700 Saved

*** Numbers Based upon Average Minimum Wage and current Make.com Service Subscription Cost…

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INSTRUCTIONS: Current process

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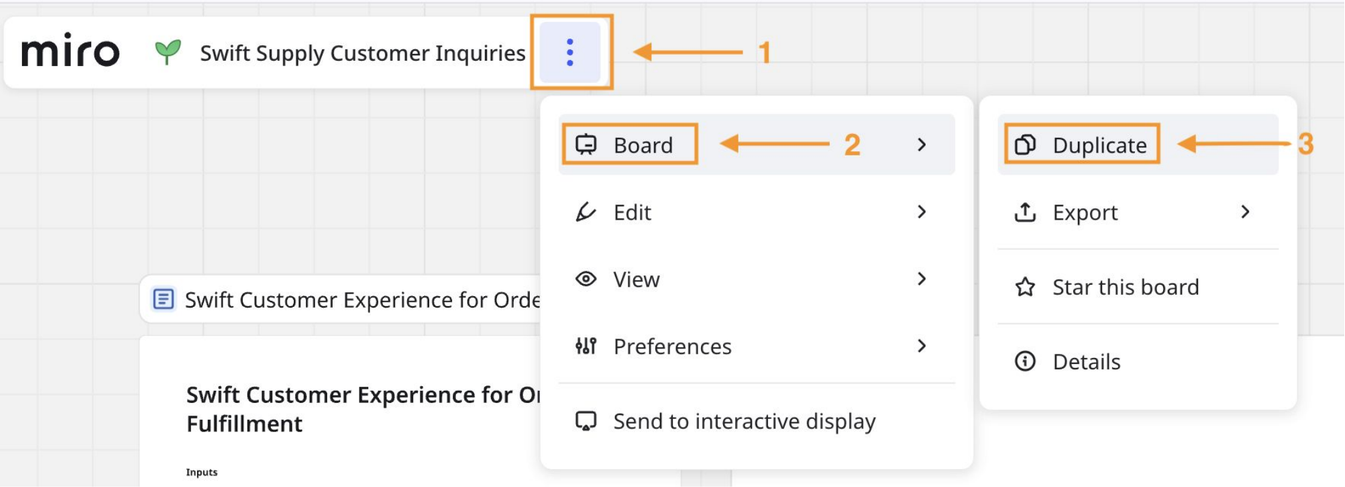

**The process steps in text and map form are included on slides 8 & 9 for your reference.

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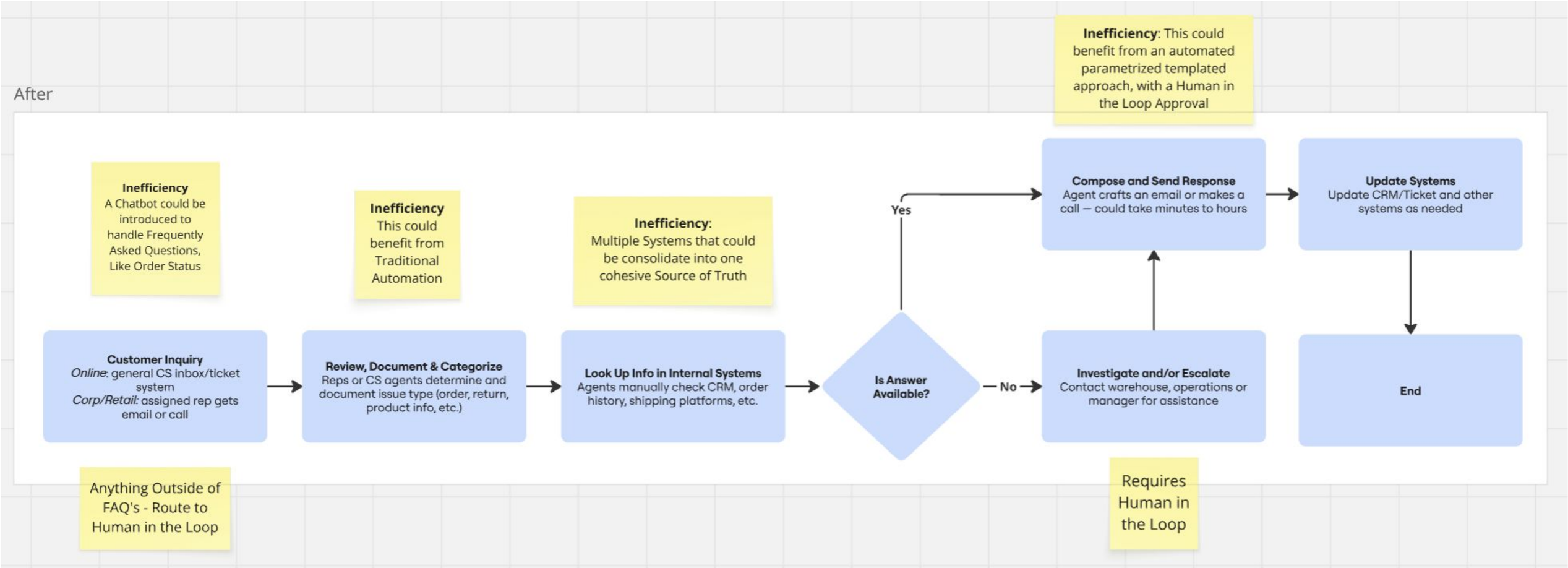
COMPLETE: Current process



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REVIEW: Current process, text description

Swift customer experience for customer inquiries

Inputs

- **Online store (main CS # / email):**
  Customers submit inquiries via web form, email, or phone — routed to the **general customer service queue** (shared inbox, call center system, or CRM ticket).
- **Corporate clients (Account reps):**
  Questions go **directly to their assigned account rep** via email or phone. The rep often acts as middleman — forwarding or handling issues manually.
- **Retail partners (B2B account reps):**
  Similar to corporate — partners reach out to their **designated rep**, who may need to escalate logistics, returns, or inventory questions manually.

Step-by-step process:

1. **Inquiry routed to person (Queue or rep)**
   - Online: Hits general CS inbox/ticket system
   - Corporate/retail: Goes to specific rep's inbox or phone
2. **Person reads and categorizes manually**
   - Reps or CS agents determine issue type (order, return, product info, etc.)
3. **Looks up information in internal systems**
   - Agents manually check CRM, order history, shipping platforms, etc.
   - If complex, may forward to warehouse, ops, or manager for help
4. **Manual response composed and sent**
   - Agent crafts an email or makes a call — could take minutes to hours
5. **Tracking / status update (sometimes manual)**
   - Status may or may not be logged in CRM depending on how busy the agent is
6. **Escalations are unstandardized**
   - Based on experience, mood, or backlog, escalations may be delayed or skipped

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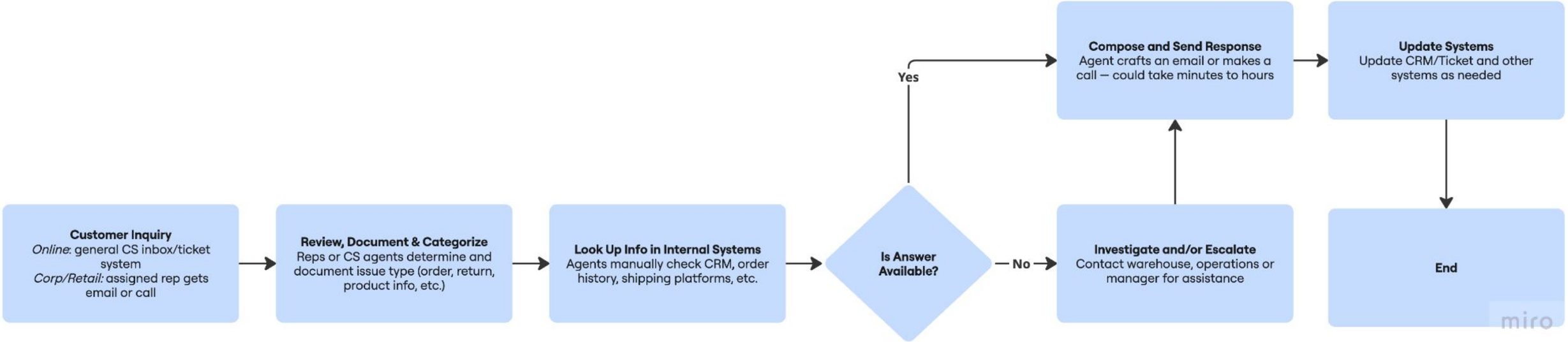
REVIEW: Current process, mapped flow

Swift customer experience for customer inquiries



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INSTRUCTIONS: Proposed process

1. Access your previously copied Miro board.
2. Review the proposed new workflow with AI automation. (Also here →)
3. Create a process map to illustrate on Miro.
4. Take a screenshot and paste on the next slide.

Proposed AI Automation Process

1. **Customer Engages With Chatbot**
   - For high-value customers, angry or upset responses, or other questions that aren't easily classifiable, the bot escalates to appropriate team or representative.
2. **Chatbot Accepts and Classifies Inquiry**
   - The chatbot automatically detects intent using natural language processing (AI) to route the inquiry to the correct workflow (returns, order status, product info, etc.).
   - If intent is unclear, it routes to a human for review (human-in-the-loop).
3. **Bot Looks Up Information in Real Time**
   - The chatbot is integrated with internal systems to pull up the relevant status or documentation immediately and formats it for the customer.
4. **Response Sent Instantly (or Escalated if Needed)**
   - If the bot is highly confident in matching the inquiry to information, it sends a full response instantly.
   - If it is not, it drafts a response and queues for human review before sending. For these and/or complex issues or requests requiring judgment (e.g., damaged items, refunds, contract terms), the bot escalates to the appropriate agent or rep.
5. **All Interactions Automatically Logged**
   - Every customer interaction (AI or human) is automatically recorded in the CRM/ticketing system against the customer record, including timestamps, channel, and resolution steps — no manual logging needed.

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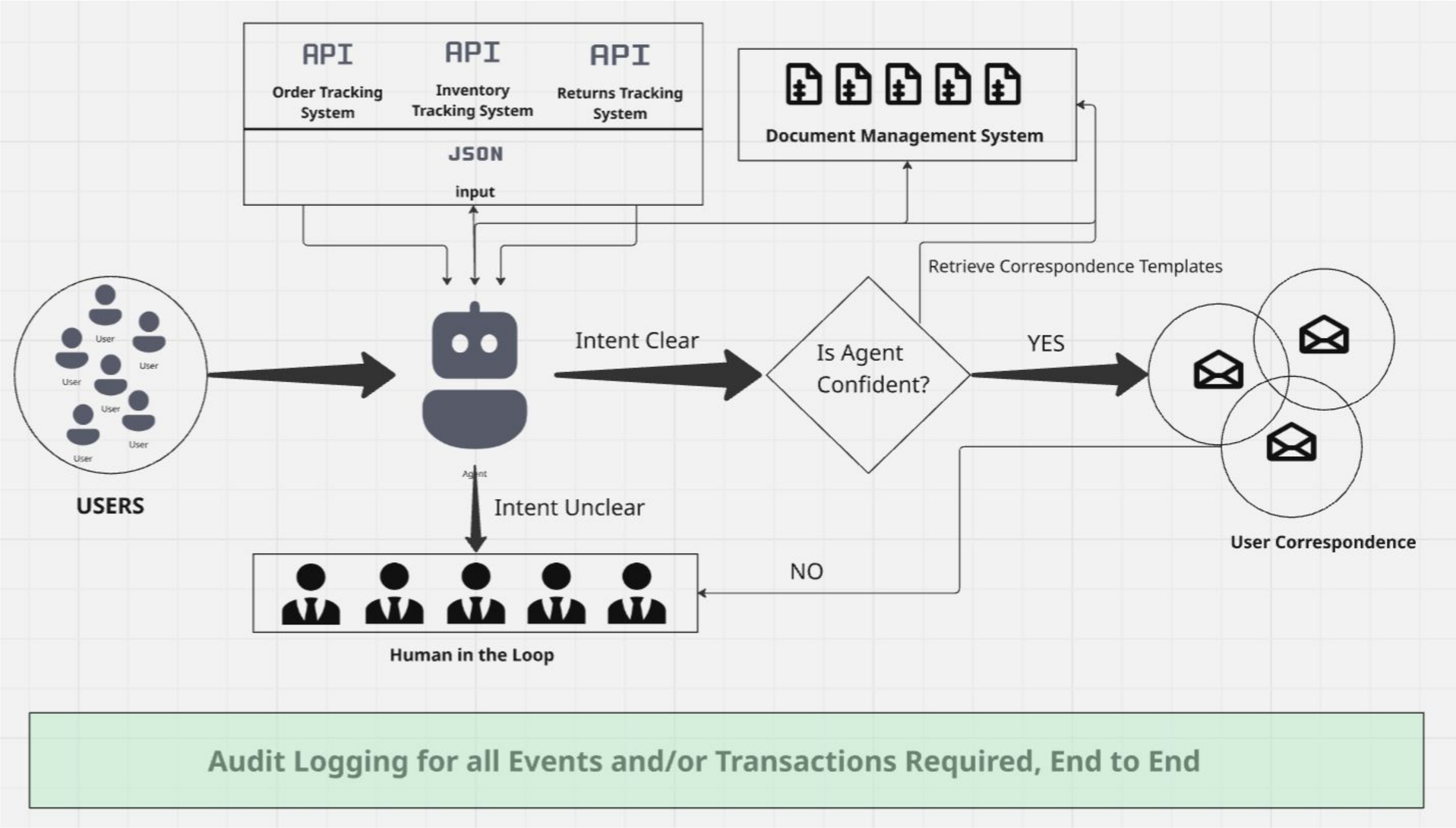
COMPLETE: Proposed process



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COMPLETE: AI feasibility review

Document the ways in which this project is well-suited to the use of AI automation by considering each of the following. Add your response for each.

- ➔ Data availability: The Order Management System and Customer Relations Managements system should contain the primary data elements necessary for automation (Order Numbers, Order History, Inventory, Shipping and Returns).

- ➔ Patterns and trend: Can be determined by Order History and how it relates to Frequently Asked Questions like;

1. "Where is my order?"
2. "What is your return window?"
3. "Will this product fit in my kitchen?"

- ➔ Scalability: Should easily scale for current support request traffic patterns. In the issue of Peak Hours or Traffic Spikes, resources can be scaled dynamically.

- ➔ Decision-making: A Rules-Based Structure can be integrated to reflect more of a Traditional Automation Workflow and provide the necessary 'Guard-rails' with respect to our Agentic Bot. This will preserve the Human in the Loop areas stages of our 'Workflow'.

- ➔ Exceptions: Upon exception there should be an encapsulating Catch that is handled graceful, logged for auditing, and handled by the Human in the Loop.

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COMPLETE: Metrics

What leading (within 90 days) and lagging (6 months+) indicators will be useful to understand if this project successfully meets its goals? List at least two in each column.

Leading (90 days)	Lagging (6 months +)
• Metric 1 - The response time of the Bot from initial request, to resolution compared to the traditional/orginal manual workflow would be of benefit. • Metric 2 - The overall number of customer requests resolved, without Human in the Loop Versus the traditional/original manual workflow would also be of benefit	• Metric 1 - Cost of Support driven out by the ChatBot as opposed to that of the original/traditional workflow. • Metric 2 - Customer retention would be a good metric at this stage. It would provide a significant pool to compare against previous forecasts.

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COMPLETE: Stakeholder review

Complete the stakeholder impact review chart below.

Stakeholder	How automation changes their work	What decisions they keep	Where human involvement is necessary
Customer service agents	Their Day to Day would change, shiftin their roles from a pure Support Role to more of a Regional Management Role Possible.	Those that require more Critical Thought, those queries and process outside of the automated workflow whether it be agentic or traditional. They could even take on more of a sales opportunities or vet new leads depending upon the supply chain sales department.	It would be those one offs or situations or conditions that are outside of the Agent AI Chatbots authority to vet. Or at times it would hallicinate, and/or get confused, or just error overall due to unclear customer requests.
Customer support manager	If the Customer Support Teams is leaning in on more of a Regional Managemente Support Role, then teh Support Manager's Role might shift from fielding less customer inquiries and more of just managing the teams itself.	They would still keep the management of a customer support team. They could then focus their efforts on T-Shaping opportunities, Train the Trainer so to speak. Convert the work environment into an opportunity for professional growth and continued education.	Determining employee performance, monitoring customer responses or satisfaction, engaging or integrating department opportunities for employee professional growth.
IT team	The shift would be more towards a systems engineer a backend or serverside engineer, maintaining the plumbing so to speak.	Possibly managing Agentic AI Bots themselves or for that matter administering and or enhancing new Agentic AI Workflow Opprotunites in addition to the plumbing mentioned previously.	Critical Thought, Architectural mindsets, determining what Automation has to offer and how else the organziation may benefit.
Customers	They are no longer waiting and should become happy or atleast happier. There will still be the occasion of escalation I am certain.	the knowledge that their order is either safely on its way or has been appropriately escalated. I guess they could ask the question of cost Am I paying for a competitively priced product? Should I look at their competitors?	the customer is the Human in the Loop. They will continue to be involved no matter the workflow.
Executives	Productivity Wave, reduction in overhead, reduction in cost with respect to customer support.	What annual and quarterly forecasts will look like. What sales if any can be adjusted to increase profit. What performance packages can be revisited or integrated.	It once again will be the Critical Thought that is preserved not matter the level of automation. It is they that manage people, and that does require a certain level of soft skills that AI is simply not capable of.

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COMPLETE: Risks & mitigations

Three potential operational risks are outlined below. Note specific strategies to mitigate each risk.

Risk: Inaccurate or incomplete responses from the AI	Risk: Customer frustration when interacting with a bot	Risk: Internal resistance or poor adoption by staff
• Monitor logging and Auditing Processes • For any inaccurate responses follow up with IT for additional or improved Guard-Rails for the Agentic AI Bot	• If numbers prove to loss of Customer Trust integrate a prompt for Human in the Loop to redirect the end user to a live agent •	• This would be unfortunate. The resistance could be out of fear or unsure of their require knowledge base. Offer continued education, training or active working sessions with fellow colleagues to alleviate uncertainty. •

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COMPLETE: Executive summary

Provide a succinct overview of your workflow proposal suitable for senior team members clearly highlighting:

➔ **Goal**: To transition Customer Support from a high-churn overwhelmed work environment**,** to a high-efficiency less stressed staff. We propose the elimination to the 24-hour response lag for routine inquiries, reclaiming 60% of team capacity to focus on high-value corporate account management shifting to more of a Regional Management Support.

➔ **Recommendation**:
➔ Implement an **AI-Driven Orchestration Layer** using Make.com to serve as a "Digital Front Door" for all inquiries.

- **Tier 0 (Automated):** Immediate resolution for order tracking (WISMO), return labels, and inventory checks via direct API integration.
- **Tier 1 (Human-in-the-Loop):** Intelligent routing that identifies high-value corporate domains or "high-frustration" sentiment, instantly escalating these cases to senior agents with a full AI-generated context summary.
- **Platform:** Make.com for its low-code agility, visual audit trails, and ability to scale without increasing IT overhead.

➔ **Metrics**:

Leading (90-Day Success):

- **Containment Rate:** Target **>60%** of total tickets resolved autonomously.
- **Speed to Resolution:** Target a **90% reduction** in "First Response Time" for routine web inquiries.

Lagging (6-Month ROI):

- **Cost Per Order:** Target a **25% decrease** in total support spend per transaction.
- **Capacity Reclaim:** Ability to handle a **30% increase** in seasonal volume without additional headcount.

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REVIEW: Self-assessment checklist

Use this checklist to review and strengthen your proposal before you share it with stakeholders. For this assignment, complete the checklist and mark each box once you have reviewed each area.

- ❑ Is the business goal clear and compelling?
- ❑ Does the future-state workflow solve the right problem?
- ❑ Are stakeholders and roles clearly identified?
- ❑ Are success metrics actionable and relevant?
- ❑ Have you addressed risks and mitigation plans?
- ❑ Is your proposal aligned with current business priorities?
- ❑ Have you prepared to answer tough stakeholder questions?

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COMPLETE: AI use in the playbook

Because this course centers on AI-powered workflows, we support your use of AI as taught and practiced in the course. Using AI tools and strategies isn't just allowed, it is required to complete assignments as interested to show your understanding of the material.

Per the course AI guidelines you are required to indicate where and how AI tools were used in your assignments (e.g., idea generation, drafting, proofreading, etc.). **Please complete the following:**

Question	Answer
Did you use AI when completing this assignment?	I did, yes.
If yes, explain how you used AI tools to assist you in completing the assignment. Include where you used it.	More for research, how business and/or management prefers format, structure, and message formats. What would be most appropriate for that audience, to be effective in the sales pitch.

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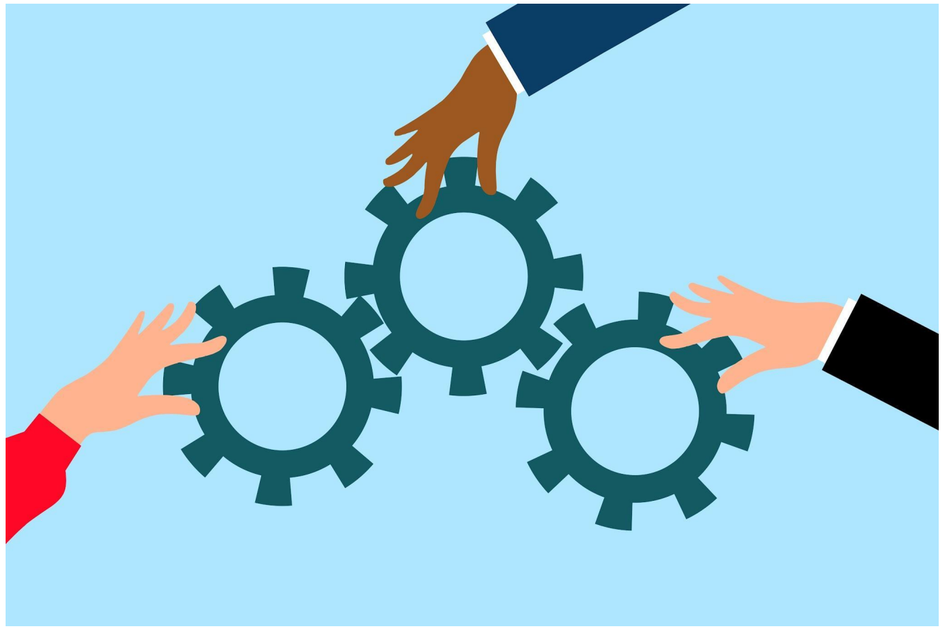
COMPANY OVERVIEW: Choose your own scenario

If you've chosen your own workplace scenario, you will complete the following slides for your chosen workflow.



REVIEW | COMPLETE | REFLECT | SUBMIT

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Your own scenario

COMPLETE: Project goal

What is the goal of implementing this AI automation? What short term and long term benefits will result?

Write your response here.

INSTRUCTIONS: Current process

1. Login to Miro, access the provided Miro board, and duplicate the board (steps →)
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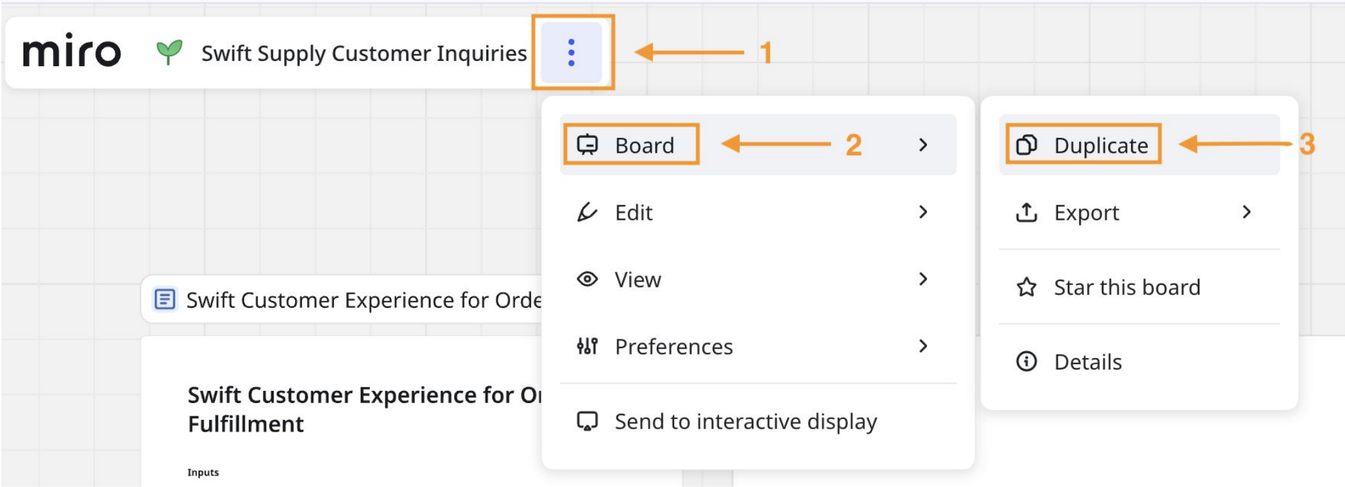

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Your own scenario

COMPLETE: Current process

Paste your screenshot below.

INSTRUCTIONS: Proposed process

1. Choose 4–6 key steps from your current process.
2. Focus on the steps that have the most significant potential for improvement.
3. Go to Miro and design your after-view map. Use simple shapes (rectangles, diamonds, arrows) to design your future process.
4. Create a process map to illustrate on Miro. You can do this below your current map that you designed.
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Your own scenario

COMPLETE: Proposed process

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Your own scenario

COMPLETE: AI feasibility review

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- ➔ Data Availability:
- ➔ Patterns and Trend:
- ➔ Scalability:
- ➔ Decision-making:
- ➔ Exceptions:

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COMPLETE: Metrics

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Your own scenario

COMPLETE: Risks & mitigations

Identify two potential operational risks. Note specific strategies to mitigate each risk.

Risk #!:	Risk #2:
• •	• •

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Your own scenario

COMPLETE: Executive Summary

Provide a succinct overview of your workflow proposal suitable for senior team members clearly highlighting:

- ➔ Goal:
- ➔ Recommendation:
- ➔ Metrics:

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INSTRUCTIONS: SUBMIT IT

Review each slide and make sure you have completed the entire assignment
Set share settings so **anyone with the link** can view the document
Access the correct assignment submission page in the Learning Management System
Copy/Paste the link to your assignment in the system by the due date
Confirm the assignment was accepted by the Learning Management System

How to set share settings:

- Click “Share” in the upper right corner
- Under “General Access”, select “**anyone with the link”**
- Click “Copy” and then “Done”
- Paste the link in the correct assignment submission page in the LMS

Watch this video for a quick demo